

What is lightning?

Lightning is a bright flash of electricity produced by some powerful storms. This happens when the raindrops in clouds turn to ice and knock together, creating electricity. When too much of this electricity builds up, it is released in the form of giant sparks called lightning.

Superstorms...

Thunderstorms are made up of several storm clouds joined together. They can stretch as wide as 20 miles (30 km) across.

Noisy flash...

A flash of lightning is burning hot. It heats up the air, which expands very quickly and produces a noisy crash of thunder. You see the lightning before you hear the thunder because light travels faster than sound.

Lightning flashes are a scorching **54,000°F (30,000°C)**—**five times hotter** than the surface of the Sun.